

DECODER

1-9

# MASTER SPECIAL POINTS DECODER

*Every Special-Point Category, Cumulative, Tiered A/B/C*

Five Shu · Yuan · Luo · Back-Shu · Front-Mu · Xi-Cleft · He-Sea · Confluent · Command · Hui-Meeting

## TIER A

*Dr. Zhang's confirmed final-exam review  
emphasis -- know cold*

## TIER B

*Quiz-tested (Quiz 1-6) and/or high  
clinical yield -- know well*

## TIER C

*Classical/reference material -- lower  
priority per Dr. Zhang's Week 9  
statement*

*This is NOT the weekly Study Guide -- it is organized BY POINT CATEGORY, not by channel.*

Use it to cross-check: "what are ALL the Yuan-Source points?" instead of "what is LU's Yuan-Source?"

Every category is cross-referenced back to the per-channel ID cards in the Final Study Guide.

## FIVE SHU (TRANSPORT) POINTS -- 60-POINT MASTER TABLE

TIER A

A specific group of 5 points on each of the 12 primary meridians, situated distal to the elbows/knees: Jing-Well (“where it emerges”, tips of fingers/toes, first aid/resuscitation), Ying-Spring (“where it flows”, before MCP/MTP, febrile disease), Shu-Stream (“where it pours”, after MCP/MTP, heaviness & joint pain), Jing-River (“where it travels”, forearm/lower leg, externally-contracted disease), He-Sea (“where it enters”, near elbow/knee, disorders of the six Fu).

| Meridian             | Jing-Well      | Ying-Spring   | Shu-Stream   | Jing-River    | He-Sea            |
|----------------------|----------------|---------------|--------------|---------------|-------------------|
| Lung (LU)            | LU11 Shaoshang | LU10 Yuji     | LU9 Taiyuan  | LU8 Jingqu    | LU5 Chize         |
| Large Intestine (LI) | LI1 Shangyang  | LI2 Erjian    | LI3 Sanjian  | LI5 Yangxi    | LI11 Quchi        |
| Stomach (ST)         | ST45 Lidui     | ST44 Neiting  | ST43 Xianggu | ST41 Jiexi    | ST36 Zusanli      |
| Spleen (SP)          | SP1 Yinbai     | SP2 Dadu      | SP3 Taibai   | SP5 Shangqiu  | SP9 Yinlingquan   |
| Heart (HT)           | HT9 Shaochong  | HT8 Shaofu    | HT7 Shenmen  | HT4 Lingdao   | HT3 Shaohai       |
| Small Intestine (SI) | SI1 Shaoze     | SI2 Qianggu   | SI3 Houxi    | SI5 Yanggu    | SI8 Xiaohai       |
| Bladder (BL)         | BL67 Zhiyin    | BL66 Zutonggu | BL65 Shugu   | BL60 Kunlun   | BL40 Weizhong     |
| Kidney (KI)          | KI1 Yongquan   | KI2 Rangu     | KI3 Taixi    | KI7 Fuli      | KI10 Yingu        |
| Pericardium (PC)     | PC9 Zhongchong | PC8 Laogong   | PC7 Daling   | PC5 Jianshi   | PC3 Quze          |
| San Jiao (SJ)        | SJ1 Guanchong  | SJ2 Yemen     | SJ3 Zhongzhu | SJ6 Zhigou    | SJ10 Tianjing     |
| Gallbladder (GB)     | GB44 Zuqiaoyin | GB43 Xiashi   | GB41 Zulinqi | GB38 Yangfu   | GB34 Yanglingquan |
| Liver (LR)           | LR1 Dadun      | LR2 Xingjian  | LR3 Taichong | LR4 Zhongfeng | LR8 Ququan        |

Yin meridians have NO separate Yuan-Source point -- the Shu-Stream point IS the Yuan point (e.g. Taiyuan LU9 is both Shu-Stream and Yuan for Lung; Taixi KI3 for Kidney). Yang meridians have a 6th, separate Yuan-Source point beyond the 5 Shu points (e.g. Chongyang ST42, Hegu LI4).

## YUAN-SOURCE POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER A

|    |                                    |    |                                          |
|----|------------------------------------|----|------------------------------------------|
| LU | LU9 Taiyuan                        | BL | BL64 Jinggu                              |
| LI | LI4 Hegu -- FORBIDDEN in pregnancy | KI | KI3 Taixi (also Shu-Stream -- dual role) |
| ST | ST42 Chongyang                     | PC | PC7 Daling                               |
| SP | SP3 Taibai                         | SJ | SJ4 Yangchi                              |
| HT | HT7 Shenmen                        | GB | GB40 Qiuxu                               |
| SI | SI4 Wangu                          | LR | LR3 Taichong                             |

On YIN channels, the Yuan-Source point IS the Shu-Stream point (dual role, same point). On YANG channels, Yuan-Source is a separate 6th point beyond the 5 Shu points.

## LUO-CONNECTING POINTS -- ALL 15

TIER A

| Luo Point      | Connection                            | Note                                                 |
|----------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| LU7 Lieque     | LU -> LI                              | also opens Ren Mai (Week 7)                          |
| LI6 Pianli     | LI -> LU                              | closest pairing around the wrist to LU7              |
| ST40 Fenglong  | ST -> SP                              | #1 phlegm point in TCM                               |
| SP4 Gongsun    | SP -> ST                              | also opens Chong Mai                                 |
| HT5 Tongli     | HT -> SI                              | 1 cun above wrist crease                             |
| SI7 Zhizheng   | SI -> HT                              | 5 cun above wrist                                    |
| BL58 Feiyang   | BL -> KI                              | 7 cun above external malleolus                       |
| KI4 Dazhong    | KI -> BL                              | posterior to internal malleolus                      |
| PC6 Neiguan    | PC -> SJ                              | also opens Yin Wei Mai                               |
| SJ5 Waiguan    | SJ -> PC                              | also opens Yang Wei Mai                              |
| GB37 Guangming | GB -> LR                              | 5 cun above external malleolus                       |
| LR5 Ligou      | LR -> GB                              | 5 cun above internal malleolus                       |
| CV15 Jiuwei    | Ren Mai collateral                    | spreads over the FRONT midline/abdomen               |
| GV1 Changqiang | Du Mai collateral                     | spreads over the BACK midline                        |
| SP21 Dabao     | Great (Major)<br>Collateral of Spleen | covers the LATERAL chest -- why there are 15, not 12 |

Connecting (Luo) points of HAND meridians cluster around the WRIST. Connecting points of FOOT meridians cluster around the ANKLE/MALLEOLUS. CV/GV/SP-Great-Luo are the exceptions, covering front midline, back midline, and lateral chest respectively.

## BACK-SHU POINTS -- ORGAN TRANSPORT SERIES (BL13-BL28)

TIER A

| Point             | Organ Treated   |
|-------------------|-----------------|
| BL13 Feishu       | Lung            |
| BL14 Jueyinshu    | Pericardium     |
| BL15 Xinshu       | Heart           |
| BL18 Ganshu       | Liver           |
| BL19 Danshu       | Gallbladder     |
| BL20 Pishu        | Spleen          |
| BL21 Weishu       | Stomach         |
| BL22 Sanjiaoshu   | San Jiao        |
| BL23 Shenshu      | Kidney          |
| BL25 Dachangshu   | Large Intestine |
| BL27 Xiaochangshu | Small Intestine |
| BL28 Pangguangshu | Bladder         |

All 12 Back-Shu points sit on the Bladder channel's inner line, 1.5 cun lateral to the spine -- roughly in organ order top-to-bottom. BL20 (Spleen) and BL21 (Stomach) sit directly adjacent and are a classic confusable pair.

## FRONT-MU POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER A

|    |                               |    |                  |
|----|-------------------------------|----|------------------|
| LU | LU1 Zhongfu (own -- unusual)  | BL | CV3 Zhongji      |
| LI | ST25 Tianshu (on ST channel)  | KI | GB25 Jingmen     |
| ST | CV12 Zhongwan                 | PC | CV17 Danzhong    |
| SP | LR13 Zhangmen (on LR channel) | SJ | CV5 Shimen       |
| HT | CV14 Jueque                   | GB | GB24 Riyue (own) |
| SI | CV4 Guanyuan                  | LR | LR14 Qimen (own) |

Front-Mu points are scattered across several channels (CV, ST, LR, GB) rather than clustered on one channel like Back-Shu -- the classic Front-Mu exam trap is assuming a point sits on its own channel (e.g. ST25 is Front-Mu of LARGE INTESTINE, not Stomach).

## XI-CLEFT POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER B

|    |               |    |              |
|----|---------------|----|--------------|
| LU | LU6 Kongzui   | BL | BL63 Jinmen  |
| LI | LI7 Wenliu    | KI | KI5 Shuiquan |
| ST | ST34 Liangqiu | PC | PC4 Ximen    |
| SP | SP8 Diji      | SJ | SJ7 Huizong  |
| HT | HT6 Yinxi     | GB | GB36 Waiqiu  |
| SI | SI6 Yanglao   | LR | LR6 Zhongdu  |

Xi-Cleft points are the go-to for ACUTE presentations of that channel's pathology (acute pain, acute bleeding, acute spasm) -- contrast with He-Sea points, used more for chronic/Fu-organ disorders.

## HE-SEA POINTS -- ALL 12 MERIDIANS

TIER B

|    |                 |    |                                             |
|----|-----------------|----|---------------------------------------------|
| LU | LU5 Chize       | BL | BL40 Weizhong (Command, back)               |
| LI | LI11 Quchi      | KI | KI10 Yingu                                  |
| ST | ST36 Zusanli    | PC | PC3 Quze                                    |
| SP | SP9 Yinlingquan | SJ | SJ10 Tianjing                               |
| HT | HT3 Shaohai     | GB | GB34 Yanglingquan (also Hui-Meeting Sinews) |
| SI | SI8 Xiaohai     | LR | LR8 Ququan                                  |

## LOWER HE-SEA POINTS -- THE 6 FU ORGANS

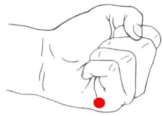
TIER B

| Point             | Fu Organ          | Use                                                       |
|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| ST37 Shangjuxu    | Large Intestine   | LI bowel disorders (diarrhea, appendicitis-type pain)     |
| ST39 Xiajuxu      | Small Intestine   | SI bowel disorders, lower abdominal pain                  |
| BL39 Weiyang      | San Jiao          | water metabolism, edema, lower back/leg pain              |
| ST36 Zusanli      | Stomach (own)     | master tonic, digestion, immunity                         |
| GB34 Yanglingquan | Gallbladder (own) | also Hui-Meeting of Sinews -- tendons, hypochondriac pain |
| BL40 Weizhong     | Bladder (own)     | also Command Point of the back                            |

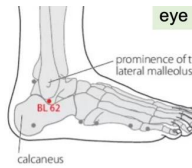
The 6 Fu (hollow) organs each have a Lower He-Sea point on the leg. ST, GB, and BL simply use their own He-Sea point (already Fu channels). LI, SI, and SJ -- despite being Hand channels -- BORROW a Lower He-Sea point on a FOOT channel (ST or BL) instead of using a point on their own pathway. This is a classic exam trap: LI's and SI's Lower He-Sea points are NOT on the LI or SI channel at all.

## EIGHT CONFLUENT POINTS -- OPEN THE 8 EXTRAORDINARY VESSELS

TIER A



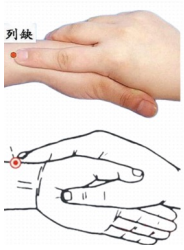
Spine pain, fever



SI3 Houxi + BL62 Shenmai

Opens: Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai

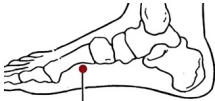
Use: posterior body, spine, neck, febrile disease



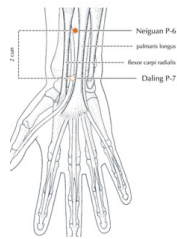
LU7 Lieque + KI6 Zhaohai

Opens: Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai

Use: throat, chest, lung, insomnia



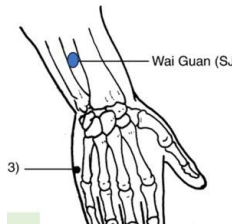
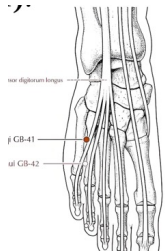
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SP4 Gongsun + PC6 Neiguan

Opens: Chong Mai + Yin Wei Mai

Use: chest, heart, stomach -- MOST-used pairing in clinic



GB41 Zulinqi + SJ5 Waiguan

Opens: Dai Mai + Yang Wei Mai

Use: lateral body, hypochondriac pain, exterior disorders

## FOUR COMMAND POINTS (SI ZONG XUE)

TIER B

| Point         | Governs Region | Note                                                   |
|---------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| ST36 Zusanli  | Abdomen        | the #1 tonic point in TCM; He-Sea + Lower He-Sea of ST |
| BL40 Weizhong | Back           | He-Sea of BL; "aspirin of acupuncture"                 |
| LU7 Lieque    | Head / Nape    | Luo of LU; also Confluent point opening Ren Mai        |
| LI4 Hegu      | Face / Mouth   | Yuan-Source of LI; FORBIDDEN in pregnancy              |

The Four Command Points (Si Zong Xue) -- a classical mnemonic distinct from, but often confused with, the 8 Confluent Points. "Command" points treat a whole body REGION; Confluent points open an Extraordinary Vessel. Some points (LU7, LI4) do double duty as both a Command point AND part of another special category -- always check whether a question is asking about regional command or vessel confluence.

## EIGHT HUI-MEETING (INFLUENTIAL) POINTS

TIER C

| Point                  | Governs             | Use                                                         |
|------------------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| CV12 Zhongwan          | Fu (Hollow) Organs  | digestive disorders, all six Fu organs                      |
| LR13 Zhangmen          | Zang (Solid) Organs | organ-level disharmony, hypochondriac pain                  |
| CV17 Danzhong          | Qi                  | chest Qi stagnation, breathing, lactation                   |
| BL17 Geshu             | Blood               | all blood disorders -- bleeding, stasis, deficiency         |
| BL11 Dazhu             | Bone                | bone disorders, also a classic exterior-releasing point     |
| GB39 Xuanzhong (Juegu) | Marrow              | marrow, brain, spinal cord, also relates to bone marrow     |
| GB34 Yanglingquan      | Sinew (Tendon)      | tendons/ligaments, also He-Sea of GB and Lower He-Sea of GB |
| LU9 Taiyuan            | Vessels (Pulse)     | all pulse/vessel disorders, also Yuan-Source of LU          |

The 8 Hui-Meeting (Influential) Points are classical CAM/MOA reference material -- each governs a tissue/substance category rather than a single channel. Not explicitly confirmed as part of Dr. Zhang's live review, but standard course-textbook material worth recognizing (Tier C).

## CROSSING (MEETING) POINTS -- BY CHANNEL

TIER C

| Channel | Count | Note                                                                                      |
|---------|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ST      | 11    | the MOST of any single primary channel -- LI20, BL1, GB3/4/6, SP1, GV24, GV26, CV12/13/24 |
| BL      | 14    | shared specifically with GV and Gallbladder, concentrated around the head                 |
| GB      | 12    | across 6 meridians (SJ, LR, PC, SI, ST, GV) -- confirmed against the 2026 slide deck      |
| SJ      | 10+   | shares crossing points with GB around head/ear/shoulder, plus GV14, SI12                  |
| SP      | 6     | abdomen/chest region -- CV3, CV4, CV10, GB24, LR14, LU1                                   |
| LR      | 6     | shared with CV (2) and SP (1) around the genital/abdomen region                           |
| SI / LI | few   | crosses GV14 and the cheek/eye/shoulder region                                            |
| HT / PC | 0     | the ONLY 2 primary channels with ZERO named crossing points -- classic paired trap        |

Per Dr. Zhang's Week 9 review, deep crossing-point memorization is lower priority than the pathway and special-point material above -- know the notable counts (ST=11 most, HT/PC=0) rather than every individual crossing point.



## CROSS-REFERENCE INDEX -- ONE ROW PER CHANNEL

Every category, side by side -- the fastest lookup in this document

| Ch | Yuan                                     | Luo            | Xi-Cleft      | He-Sea                                      | Back-Shu                | Front-Mu                      | Confluent/Cmd                                 |
|----|------------------------------------------|----------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| LU | LU9 Taiyuan                              | LU7 Lieque     | LU6 Kongzui   | LU5 Chize                                   | BL13 Feishu             | LU1 Zhongfu (own -- unusual)  | LU7 -- opens Ren Mai (paired w/ K16)          |
| LI | LI4 Hegu -- FORBIDDEN in pregnancy       | LI6 Pianli     | LI7 Wenliu    | LI11 Quchi                                  | BL25 Dachangshu         | ST25 Tianshu (on ST channel)  | LI4 -- face/mouth                             |
| ST | ST42 Chongyang                           | ST40 Fenglong  | ST34 Liangqiu | ST36 Zusanli                                | BL21 Weishu             | CV12 Zhongwan                 | ST36 -- abdomen; Lower He-Sea ST37 (LI) / ST  |
| SP | SP3 Taibai                               | SP4 Gongsun    | SP8 Diji      | SP9 Yinlingquan                             | BL20 Pishu              | LR13 Zhangmen (on LR channel) | SP4 -- opens Chong Mai (paired w/ PC6)        |
| HT | HT7 Shenmen                              | HT5 Tongli     | HT6 Yinxi     | HT3 Shaohai                                 | BL15 Xinshu             | CV14 Jueque                   | none                                          |
| SI | SI4 Wangu                                | SI7 Zhizheng   | SI6 Yanglao   | SI8 Xiaohai                                 | BL27 Xiaochangshu       | CV4 Guanyuan                  | SI3 Houxi -- opens Du Mai (paired w/ BL62)    |
| BL | BL64 Jinggu                              | BL58 Feiyang   | BL63 Jinmen   | BL40 Weizhong (Command, back)               | BL28 Pangguangshu (own) | CV3 Zhongji                   | BL62 Shenmai -- opens Yang Qiao Mai (paired)  |
| KI | KI3 Taixi (also Shu-Stream -- dual role) | KI4 Dazhong    | KI5 Shuiquan  | KI10 Yingu                                  | BL23 Shenshu            | GB25 Jingmen                  | KI6 Zhaohai -- opens Yin Qiao Mai (paired w/  |
| PC | PC7 Daling                               | PC6 Neiguan    | PC4 Ximen     | PC3 Quze                                    | BL14 Jueyinshu          | CV17 Danzhong                 | PC6 -- opens Yin Wei Mai (paired w/ SP4) --   |
| SJ | SJ4 Yangchi                              | SJ5 Waiguan    | SJ7 Huizong   | SJ10 Tianjing                               | BL22 Sanjiaoshu         | CV5 Shimen                    | SJ5 -- opens Yang Wei Mai (paired w/ GB41)    |
| GB | GB40 Qixu                                | GB37 Guangming | GB36 Waiqiu   | GB34 Yanglingquan (also Hui-Meeting Sinews) | BL19 Danshu             | GB24 Riyue (own)              | GB41 Zulinqi -- opens Dai Mai (paired w/ SJ5) |
| LR | LR3 Taichong                             | LR5 Ligou      | LR6 Zhongdu   | LR8 Ququan                                  | BL18 Ganshu             | LR14 Qimen (own)              | none directly (LR13 is the SP Front-Mu; LR14  |